

Paper 1: Business Studies

Content overview

Students need to demonstrate specified knowledge and critical understanding of the following sections:

- 1 Business Activity and the Changing Environment
- 2 Human Resources (HR)
- 3 Accounting and Finance
- 4 Marketing
- 5 Production.

Section 1: Introduces the nature and types of business within an economy and encourages students to examine the interaction between businesses and the environment within which they operate.

Sections 2–5: Focus on the main functional areas of business – HR, accounting and finance, marketing and production.

Whilst the five sections of content are listed as discrete topics it is important for students to recognise that, because business is dynamic, these five areas interrelate.

Section	Content summary
1 Business Activity and the Changing Environment	This section examines the objectives of businesses, the changing environment and the criteria for judging success. The focus is on the importance of having clear business objectives and how the business environment provides opportunities for, and imposes constraints on, the pursuit of those objectives.
2 Human Resources	This section looks at people in organisations focusing on their roles, relationships and management in business.
3 Accounting and Finance	This section explores the use of accounting and financial information as an aid to decision making.
4 Marketing	This section focuses on identifying and satisfying customer needs in a changing and competitive international environment.
5 Production	This section examines the way organisations use and manage resources to produce goods and services.